

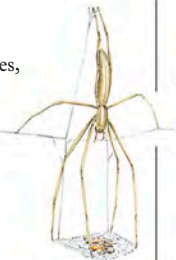
Ready to attack

This Australian funnel-web spider is one of the world's deadliest. Here it is poised, ready to attack! When spiders catch their prey, usually insects, they use their fangs to poison and kill them. The funnel-web spider, like most spiders, uses its strong digestive juices to dissolve the insect's insides so the spider can suck it dry.



Spiders and webs

The net-casting spider lives in trees, mostly in jungle areas. To catch prey, it spins a sticky net and throws it over passing insects.



The water spider spins a web in the shape of a bell under the water. It fills the bell with a bubble of air and moves in.

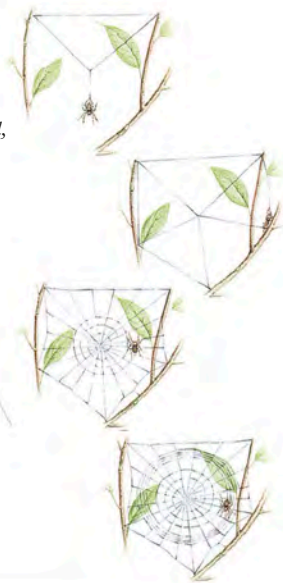
The web of an orb-web spider looks like a target. It takes about an hour to spin a complete web.



The female purse web spider lives in a silken pouch. When an unsuspecting insect lands on top, the spider bites through the pouch and grabs it.

Making a web

Making a web takes time and special care. Spiders only spin new webs when the old ones become messy or damaged.



Most web spiders have eight simple eyes, called ocelli. But even so, they cannot see very well.

Spiders have a pair of small, leglike appendages, called palps, on each side of their mouthparts. They help spiders smell, taste, and detect prey.

Spiders have eight legs.

Even though spiders do not have ears, they can "listen" to the world around them through their webs. The webs are very sensitive to vibrations in the air.

